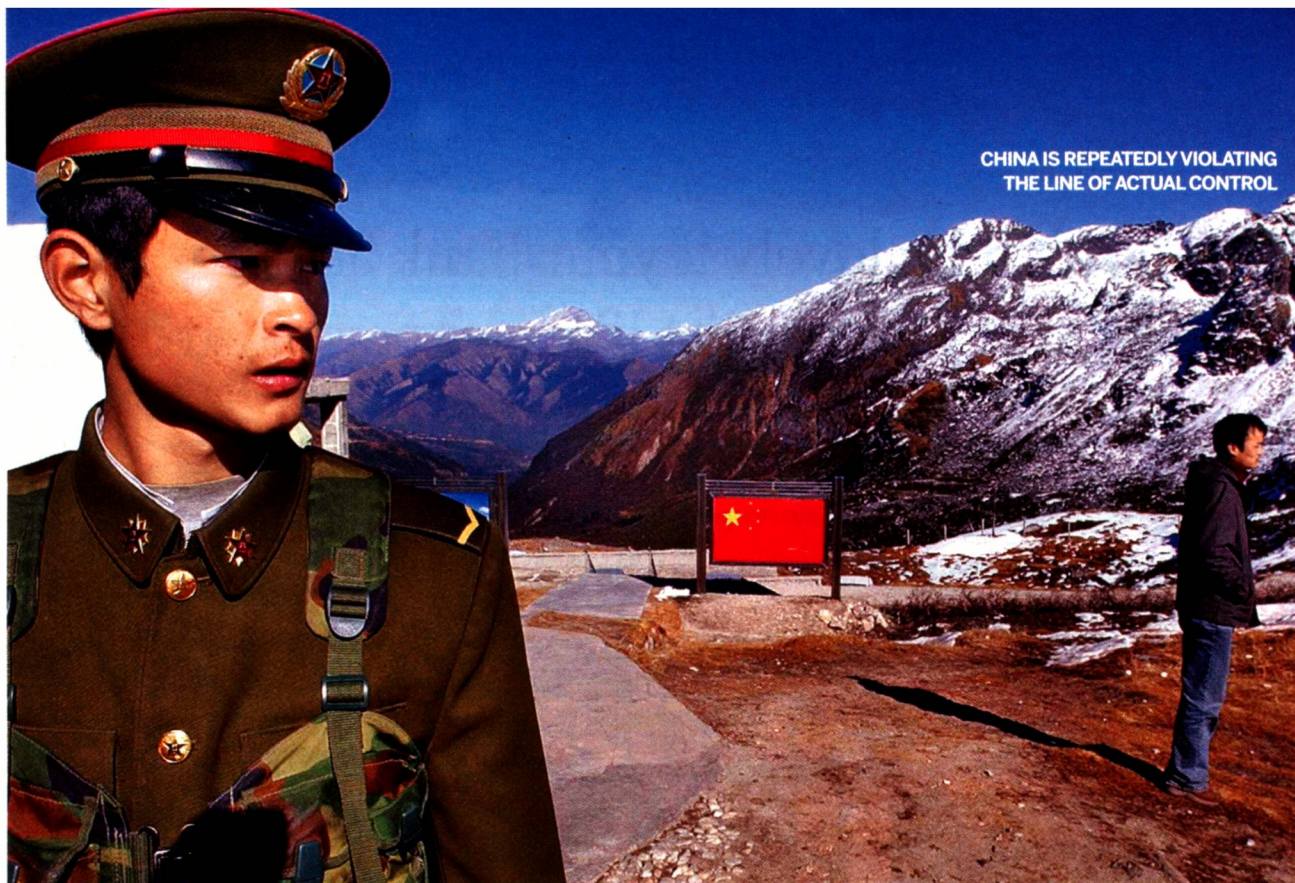




How to deal with an **AGGRESSIVE CHINA?**

The BEST opinion is that India should stand firm in the face of an increasingly belligerent China. We should stick to our stand on Arunachal, even as we continue to engage with them.

Raj Chengappa: Tensions between India and China have inexplicably risen in recent months. Is the threat from China real or imagined? What should India's counter be to an aggressive China?

G. Parthasarathy: China decides things on an objective analysis of the balance of power. Now they see us with a huge differential of power, national power—diplomatic, military, and economic—and yet they remain

a bit concerned about whether they would be able to dominate in Asia. China is not only a threat but a challenge. Know one thing for sure, that China is determined to contain India; it does so by the nuclear weapons transfer to Pakistan, by improving their nuclear capabilities and providing them with various other things. We can talk to China and engage them but we cannot be under an illusion or get hysterical. If we don't al-

low the Dalai Lama to go to Tawang, we will send a completely wrong signal of weakness. We should go ahead and do what we must to make the point clear that Arunachal Pradesh is ours and it will stay ours. India is not the only neighbour with whom China has had these problems.

Ajit Kumar Doval: The Chinese threat is real and multi-dimensional. China is aiming to leverage the differential between the comprehensive

THE BIG QUESTION

SHOULD INDIA ALLOW THE DALAI LAMA TO GO TO TAWANG?

THE BEST VIEW: A UNANIMOUS YES